around the motivation of your team. What's better is that you'll have tasks that relate to the happiness of your team.

If you look at measuring improvement of effectiveness of your development team in this context, you can look at frequency of delivery. You can measure that with the following metrics:

- ***Lead time*** —The amount of time it takes from inception to delivery of tasks
- ***Development time*** —The time from when a task enters the development flow to its completion
- ***Deploy frequency*** —How often you get changes out to consumers
- ***Good/failed builds*** —How frequently you're delivering working software

Measuring autonomy with the data you have isn't very straightforward. I've had success with this by checking the counts of people entering and commenting tasks in the system before they enter the work stream along with the counts of people who are assigned the tasks. In very autonomous teams you'll see that assignees have enough ownership to collaborate toward the definition of a task before it gets assigned to the team. In teams that simply receive marching orders, you typically see members outside the immediate team doing the bulk of the creation and definition of tasks. Another pattern to look out for is nonteam members moving tasks through the workflow. A pictorial representation is shown in figure 10.10.

Figure 10.10. A pictorial representation of the overlap between task assignees and creators and how it relates to the level of team autonomy

